

Danger, stay away!

Most forest creatures are harmless, but some bite if they feel threatened, and others, like certain caterpillars, have stinging hairs on their bodies to ward off predators. Not all plants are human-friendly, either, so unless you are sure they won't give you a rash—or worse—don't touch them.

Dangerous fungi

Bright colors are often nature's warning signals, so avoid touching any yellow or red fungi. Many mushrooms and toadstools contain toxic chemicals, which, if eaten, can kill you. Some are even deadly just to touch. The safest practice is to leave all fungi alone.



Biting bugs

Many insects have bites and stings. Spider bites can be painful, and some are even deadly. Some beetles can nip if picked up and ants, bees, and wasps can sting. Ticks are stealthy, and can bite you without you feeling it. Always check yourself carefully for stowaways after a walk in the woods.

